CHINA

Real GDP growth rate: **5.2%**

GDP: $ **17.7** tn

Per capita income: $ **12,614**

Population: **1.40** bn

THE CRISIS

The bloody clash in Galwan in 2020 led to the biggest stand-off between Indian and Chinese armies on the LAC, sending ties into a deep freeze. The stalemate continues, with China refusing to vacate some areas it had intruded into

INDIA'S WORRY

↘ The China-Russia "unlimited friendship" could jeopardise India's security interests, with Beijing setting up bases and fortifying positions

↘ Its growing clout in each South Asian nation through infrastructure projects can encircle India

NEPAL

Real GDP growth rate: **0.8%**

GDP: $ **41** bn

Per capita income: $ **1,320**

Population: **31** mn

THE CRISIS

Nepal's politics is going through a shuffle as pro-China K.P. Sharma Oli of the Communist Party of Nepal-Unified Marxist-Leninist (CPN-UML) is sworn in as PM on July 14 in a coalition with the Nepali Congress, seen as pro-India

INDIA'S WORRY

↘ Nepal has included Kalapani, Limpiyadhura and Lipulekh (in Uttarakhand) as part of Nepali territory in maps. India has rejected it but it remains a thorn in ties

↘ China has overtaken India as Nepal's top foreign investor. The new dispensation may favour Beijing

BANGLADESH

Real GDP growth rate: **6%**

GDP: $ **446.3** bn

Per capita income: $ **2,620**

Population: **170** mn

THE CRISIS

Long-serving Bangladesh PM Sheikh Hasina flees her country as a student-led agitation over job quotas snowballs into a popular revolt against her authoritarian rule. Though an interim government has taken charge, the situation remains fluid

INDIA'S WORRY

↘ Pro-India Hasina had shut down anti-India activities, including those by Northeast militant groups. Hardline Islamic groups may pose a threat too

↘ Progress on bilateral cooperation like power projects could be impacted, and China may make inroads into Bangladesh

MYANMAR

Real GDP growth rate: **2.5%**

GDP: $ **64.5** bn

Per capita income: $ **1,190**

Population: **54.21** mn

THE CRISIS

Civil war continues to roil the nation ever since the military junta overthrew the government of Aung San Suu Kyi in February 2021. The generals currently control less than 50 per cent of the land

INDIA'S WORRY

↘ The fighting impacts India's Kaladan Multimodal Transit Transport Project aimed at developing Northeast India

↘ The war caused 50,000 Myanmarese to pour into Mizoram, Manipur, Nagaland and Arunachal Pradesh. Northeastern militant groups the junta had targeted may regroup

Source for economic figures: BIMSTEC-CII report 2024, World Bank, IMF; GDP is nominal; All figures are for 2023